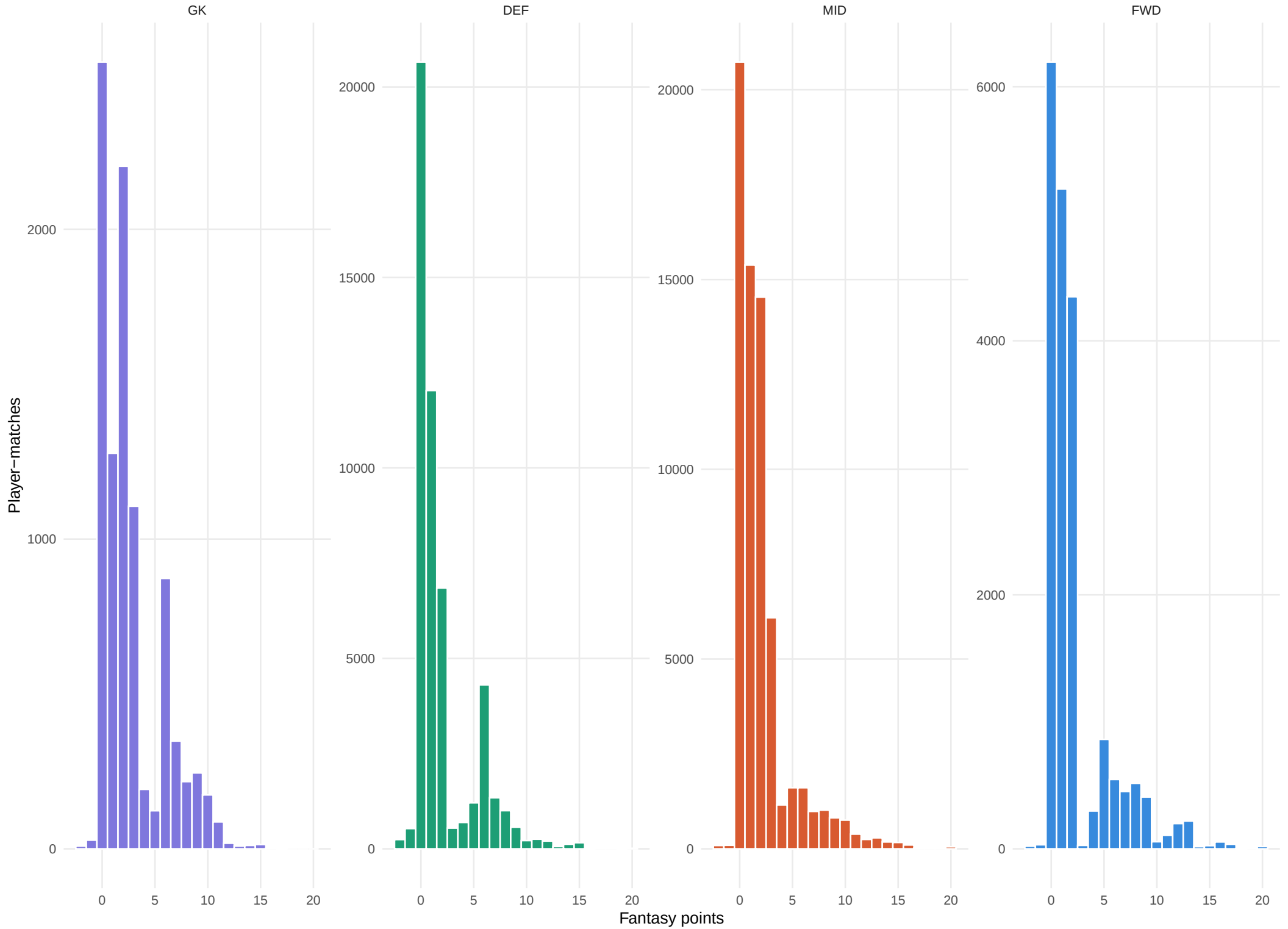
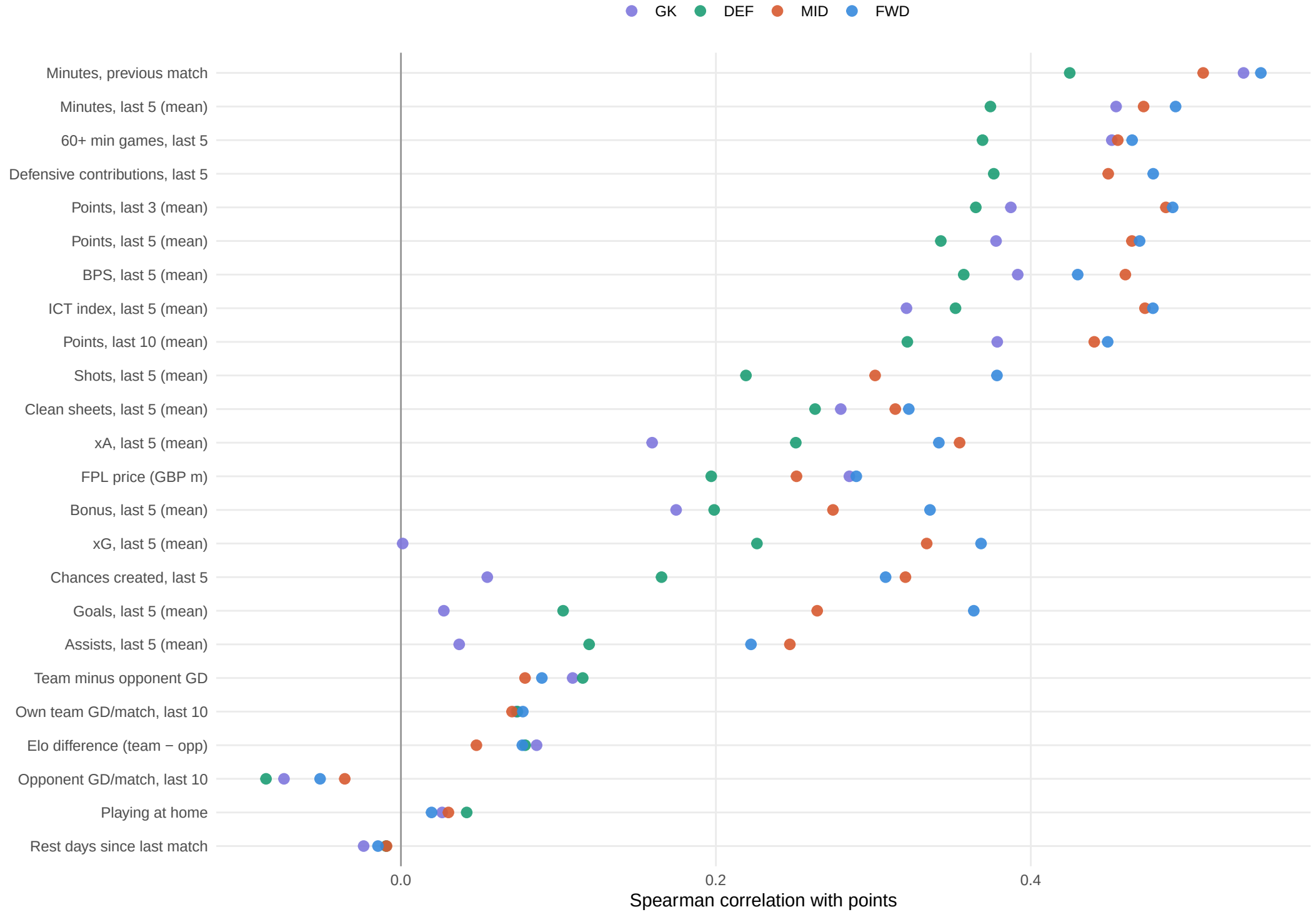
The target: points per match are mostly 0 to 2 with a long right tail

Clipped to −2 to 20 for display. A model will need to handle this skew.



Which pre−match factors move with fantasy points?

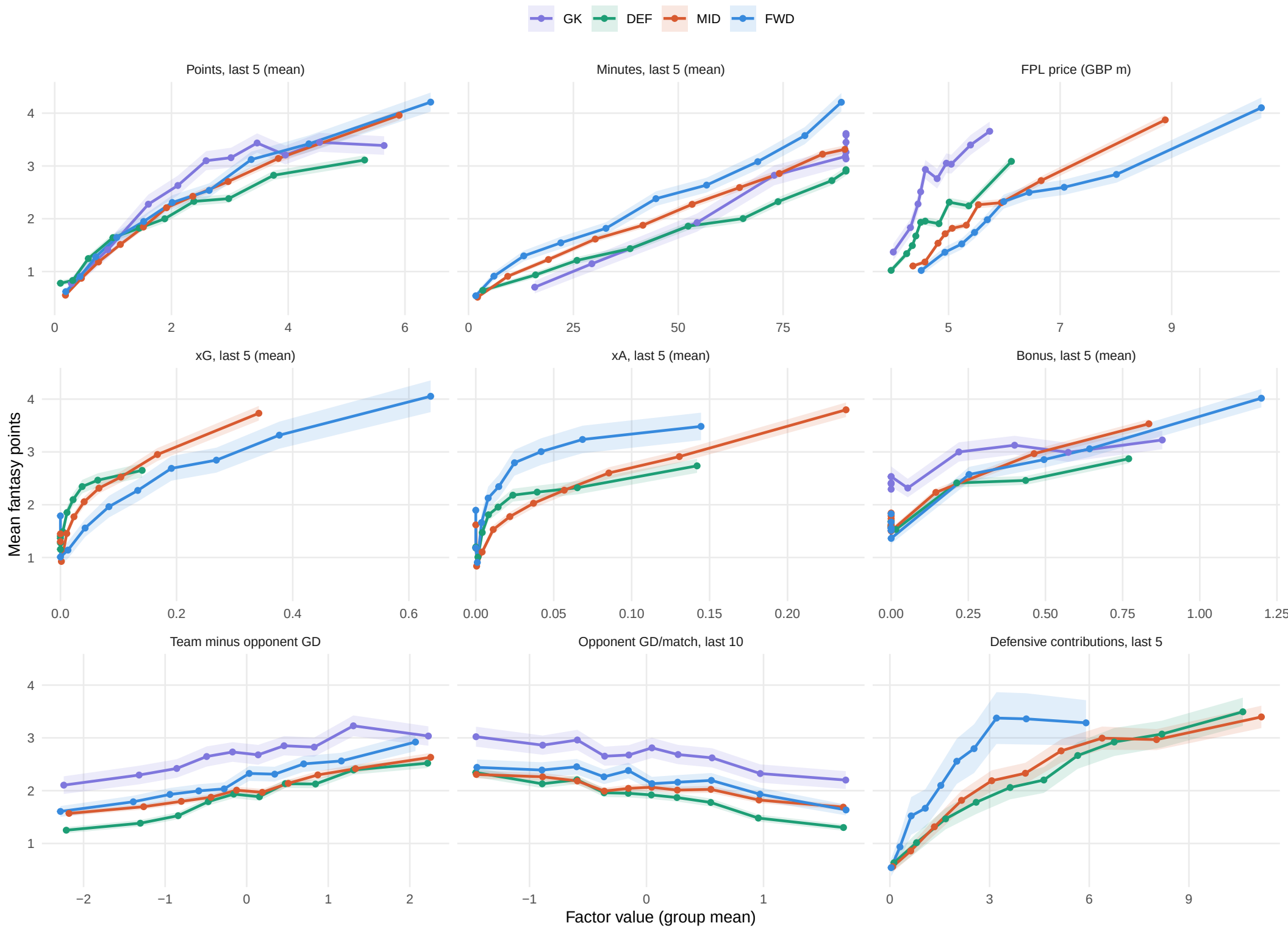
Spearman correlation with points in the match, by position. Sorted by average strength.

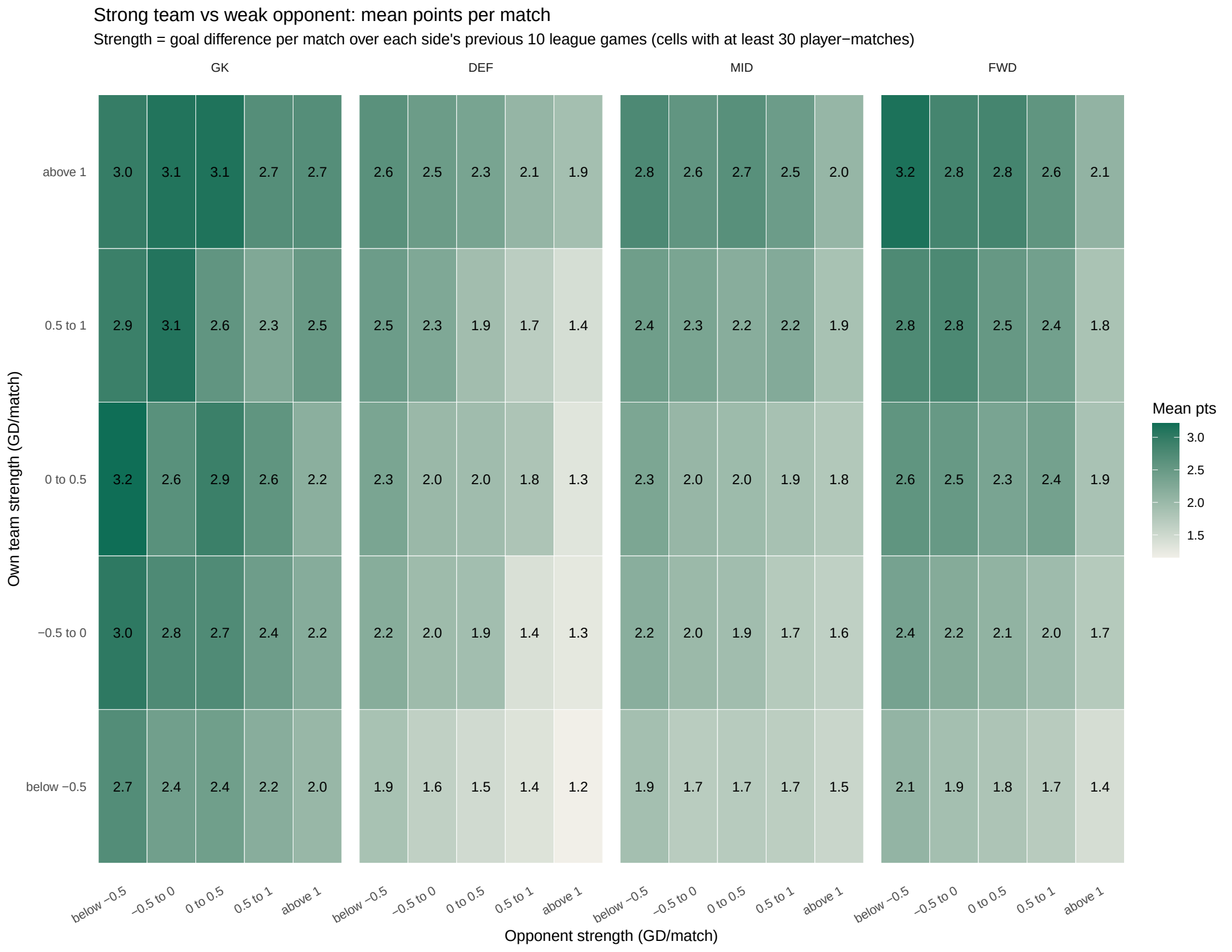


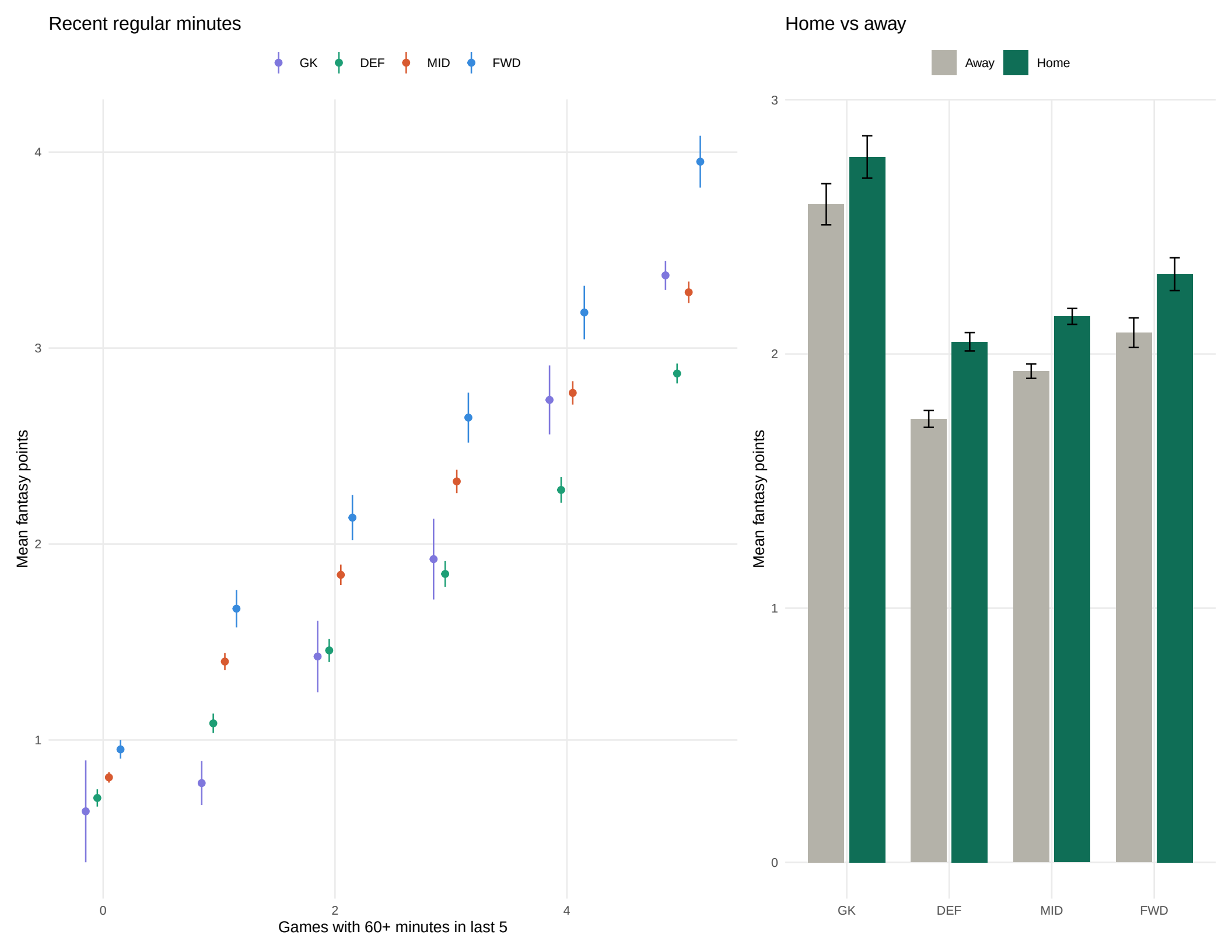
xG/xA from 2022−23; defensive contributions, shots, chances and Elo from 2025−26 only.

Shape of each relationship

Factor split into 10 equal−sized groups per position; line = mean points, band = 95% CI




Strong team vs weak opponent: mean points per match
Strength = goal difference per match over each side's previous 10 league games (cells with at least 30 player−matches)
GK
DEF
MID
FWD
Own team strength (GD/match)
above 1
0.5 to 1
0 to 0.5
−0.5 to 0
below −0.5
3.0 3.1 3.1 2.7 2.7
2.6 2.5 2.3 2.1 1.9
2.8 2.6 2.7 2.5 2.0
3.2 2.8 2.8 2.6 2.1
2.9 3.1 2.6 2.3 2.5
2.5 2.3 1.9 1.7 1.4
2.4 2.3 2.2 2.2 1.9
2.8 2.8 2.5 2.4 1.8
3.2 2.6 2.9 2.6 2.2
2.3 2.0 2.0 1.8 1.3
2.3 2.0 2.0 1.9 1.8
2.6 2.5 2.3 2.4 1.9
3.0 2.8 2.7 2.4 2.2
2.2 2.0 1.9 1.4 1.3
2.2 2.0 1.9 1.7 1.6
2.4 2.2 2.1 2.0 1.7
2.7 2.4 2.4 2.2 2.0
1.9 1.6 1.5 1.4 1.2
1.9 1.7 1.7 1.7 1.5
2.1 1.9 1.8 1.7 1.4
below −0.5
−0.5 to 0
0 to 0.5
0.5 to 1
above 1
Opponent strength (GD/match)
Mean pts
3.0
2.5
2.0
1.5


Recent regular minutes
GK
DEF
MID
FWD
Mean fantasy points
Games with 60+ minutes in last 5
0
2
4
1
2
3
4
Home vs away
Away
Home
Mean fantasy points
0
1
2
3
GK
DEF
MID
FWD